

Building and evaluation of a PBPK model for tizanidine in adults

Version	2.0-OSP12.3
based on <i>Model Snapshot and Evaluation Plan</i>	https://github.com/Open-Systems-Pharmacology/Tizanidine-Model/releases/tag/v2.0
OSP Version	12.3
Qualification Framework Version	3.7

This evaluation report and the corresponding PK-Sim project file are filed at:

<https://github.com/Open-Systems-Pharmacology/OSP-PBPK-Model-Library/>

Table of Contents

- [1 Introduction](#)
- [2 Methods](#)
 - [2.1 Modeling Strategy](#)
 - [2.2 Data](#)
 - [2.3 Model Parameters and Assumptions](#)
- [3 Results and Discussion](#)
 - [3.1 Final input parameters](#)
 - [3.2 Diagnostics Plots](#)
 - [3.3 Concentration-Time Profiles](#)
 - [3.3.1 Model Building](#)
 - [3.3.2 Model Verification](#)
- [4 Conclusion](#)
- [5 References](#)
- [6 Glossary](#)

1 Introduction

The presented PBPK model of tizanidine has been developed to be used in a PBPK Drug-Drug-Interactions (DDI) network with tizanidine as a substrate of CYP1A2.

Tizanidine is a centrally acting skeletal muscle relaxant generally used for the symptomatic treatment of acute painful muscle spasms and chronic spasticity resulting from diverse neurologic disorders ([Granfors 2004](#)).

Absorption: After oral administration of tizanidine-HCl it is absorbed fast and completely with peak plasma concentrations reached within 1 hour. Administration of tizanidine together with food increases plasma concentrations. The influence of food on the concentration-time profile is also dependent on the formulation. A capsule given with food leads to a prolonged T_{max}, with a C_{max} slightly lower than when the drug is given without food. In contrast, giving the tablet with food leads to higher peak concentrations while T_{max} remains unchanged.

Distribution: Approximately 30% is bound to plasma proteins. The concentration-time profile elicits a monophasic shape.

Metabolism: Over 95% of a dose is metabolized. The main enzyme system involved in the metabolism of tizanidine is CYP1A2.

Excretion: Only a minor part of the dose is recovered unchanged in the urine <5%.

2 Methods

2.1 Modeling Strategy

The general workflow for building an adult PBPK model has been described by Kuepfer et al. ([Kuepfer 2016](#)). Relevant information on the anthropometry (height, weight) was gathered from the respective clinical study, if reported. Information on physiological parameters (e.g. blood flows, organ volumes, hematocrit) in adults was gathered from the literature and has been incorporated in PK-Sim® as described previously ([Willmann 2007](#)). The applied activity and variability of plasma proteins and active processes that are integrated into PK-Sim® are described in the publicly available 'PK-Sim® Ontogeny Database Version 7.3' ([PK-Sim Ontogeny Database Version 7.3](#)).

Since concentration-time profiles following intravenous administration are not publicly available, model building was based on data following oral administration. In general, the following step-wise workflow was followed:

1. Fit intrinsic CL of CYP1A2, and Weibull absorption parameters (renal elimination fixed to GFR) using data from single dose studies where 4 or 8 mg tablets were given in the fasted state to healthy volunteers. The fitting was done for each of the five tissue distribution models available in PK-Sim.
2. Predictions for fed-state. If adjustments are necessary, only absorption relevant parameters are fitted.
 - Tablet-Fed (2, 4, 8 mg)
 - Capsule-Fed (4, 8 mg)
3. Model evaluation: Predict multiple dosing of 4 mg (tablet, fasted) using the best model and parameters from the previous step. If no adjustment of parameters is necessary, move on to next step.

The predefined "Standard European Male for DDI" individual (age = 30 y, weight = 73 kg, height = 176 cm, BMI = 23.57 kg/m²) was used for simulations.

Simulations of capsule administrations in fed state were carried out by adding the "High-fat breakfast" meal event at time = 0 in PK-Sim. Simulations of tablets administration in fed state were carried out without a food event but with adjusted dissolution profile.

To judge the predictive variability of the model, a population simulation was carried out generating a virtual population of 2000 healthy European male subjects with the weight and age range according to [Granfors 2004](#) (21 – 31 years, 65 – 83 kg).

Details about input data (physicochemical, *in vitro* and clinical) can be found in [Section 2.2](#).

Details about the structural model and its parameters can be found in [Section 2.3](#).

2.2 Data

2.2.1 In vitro and physico-chemical data

A literature search was performed to collect available information on physico-chemical properties of tizanidine ([Table 1](#)).

Parameter	Unit	Value	Source	Description
MW ⁺	g/mol	253.711	DrugBank DB00697	Molecular weight
pK _{a,base} ⁺		7.49	DrugBank DB00697	Acidic dissociation constant
Solubility (pH) ⁺	mg/mL	0.133 (7.4)	DrugBank DB00697	Aqueous Solubility
logP ⁺		1.4	DrugBank DB00697	Partition coefficient
f _u ⁺	%	70	SmPC tizanidine	Fraction unbound in plasma
Intrinsic CL	ml/min/kg	17	Granfors 2004	Predicted from microsomal assay

Table 1: Physico-chemical and *in-vitro* metabolization properties of tizanidine extracted from literature.

⁺: Value used in final model

2.2.2 Clinical data

A literature search was performed to collect available clinical data on tizanidine ([Table 2](#)).

Source	Dose [mg]/ Schedule *	Pop.	Age [yrs] (mean or range)	Weight [kg] (mean or range)	Sex	N	Form.	Fasted or Fed	Comment
Momo 2010 ⁺	2	HV	29	70	m	12	Tablet	Fed	
Granfors 2004 ⁺	4	HV	21-31	65-83	m	10	Tablet	Fasted	
Schellenberger 1999	4 t.i.d.	HV	19-37	70-97	m	12	Tablet	Fasted	
Henney 2007 ⁺	4	HV	26	71	m12/f6	18	Tablet /Capsule	Fed	
Backman 2008 ⁺	4	HV	23	78	m	38	Tablet	Fasted	Male/female-non-smokers and male-smokers
Backman 2006 ⁺	4	HV	21	71	m6/f4	10	Tablet	Fasted	Only control group used
Shah 2006	8	HV	18-52	46-102	m54/f42	96	Tablet / Capsule	Fed/ Fasted	
Henney 2008	6	HV	18-39	NA	m19/f9	27	Capsule	Fasted	
Tse 1987	4 t.i.d.	HV	21-48	57-86	m	6	Tablet	Fasted	
Al-Ghazawi 2013 ⁺	4	HV	28	75	m	36	Tablet	Fasted	

Table 2: Literature sources of clinical concentration data of tizanidine used for model development and validation. *: single dose unless otherwise specified; EM: extensive metabolizers; ⁺: Data used for final parameter identification

2.3 Model Parameters and Assumptions

2.3.1 Absorption

Release of tizanidine from the tablet is modelled using the Weibull-formulation, with parameter values identified by fitting the model to observed concentration profiles after po administration of 4 and 8 mg to healthy volunteers after an overnight fast.

The same parameter values are used for the capsule and tablet formulations in fasted state. In the fed state, the capsule formulation is equal to that in the fasted state. For the tablet formulation, the

parameter values differ from those in fasted state.

2.3.2 Distribution

Physico-chemical parameters were set to the reported values (see [Section 2.2.1](#)). It was assumed that the major binding partner in plasma is albumin.

After testing the available organ-plasma partition coefficient and cell permeability calculation methods available in PK-Sim, observed clinical data were best described by choosing the partition coefficient calculation by `Berezhkovskiy` and cellular permeability calculation by `PK-Sim Standard`.

2.3.3 Metabolism and Elimination

Metabolization of tizanidine is modeled as CYP1A2 Intrinsic clearance. with parameter `Intrinsic clearance` being identified by fitting the model to concentration data after po administration.

Glomerular filtration with `GFR fraction = 1` has been assumed.

2.3.4 Automated Parameter Identification

Following parameter values were estimated for the base model:

- Intrinsic CL (CYP1A2)
- Dissolution shape (Weibull formulation)
- Dissolution time (50% dissolved) (Weibull formulation)

3 Results and Discussion

The next sections show:

1. Final model input parameters for the building blocks: [Section 3.1](#).
2. Overall goodness of fit: [Section 3.2](#).
3. Simulated vs. observed concentration-time profiles for the clinical studies used for model building and for model verification: [Section 3.3](#).

3.1 Final input parameters

The parameter values of the final PBPK model are illustrated below.

Compound: Tizanidine

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin	Alternative	Default
Solubility at reference pH	0.133 mg/ml	Database-DrugBank DB00697	S_aq	True
Reference pH	7.4	Database-DrugBank DB00697	S_aq	True
Lipophilicity	1.4 Log Units	Database-DrugBank DB00697	LogP	True
Fraction unbound (plasma, reference value)	0.7	Unknown-SmPC tizanidine	fu_plasma	True
Cl	1	Database-DrugBank DB00697		
Is small molecule	Yes			
Molecular weight	253.711 g/mol	Database-DrugBank DB00697		
Plasma protein binding partner	Albumin			

Calculation methods

Name	Value
Partition coefficients	Berezhkovskiy
Cellular permeabilities	PK-Sim Standard

Processes

Metabolizing Enzyme: CYP1A2-CLint

Species: Human

Molecule: CYP1A2

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin
Intrinsic clearance	7.2862 l/min	Parameter Identification

Systemic Process: Glomerular Filtration-Assumption

Species: Human

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin
GFR fraction	1	Other-Assumption

Formulation: Tizanidine tablet fasted

Type: Weibull

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin
Dissolution time (50% dissolved)	38.5287 min	Parameter Identification
Lag time	0 min	
Dissolution shape	0.963	Parameter Identification
Use as suspension	Yes	

Formulation: Tizanidine tablet fed

Type: Weibull

Parameters

Name	Value	Value Origin
Dissolution time (50% dissolved)	3.7642 min	Parameter Identification
Lag time	0 min	
Dissolution shape	0.3881	Parameter Identification
Use as suspension	Yes	

3.2 Diagnostics Plots

The following section displays the goodness-of-fit visual diagnostic plots for the PBPK model performance of all data listed in [Section 2.2.2](#).

The first plot shows observed versus simulated plasma concentration, the second weighted residuals versus time.

Table 3-1: GMFE for Tizanidine concentration in plasma

Group	GMFE
Oral administration (model building)	1.52
Oral administration (model validation)	1.77
All	1.65

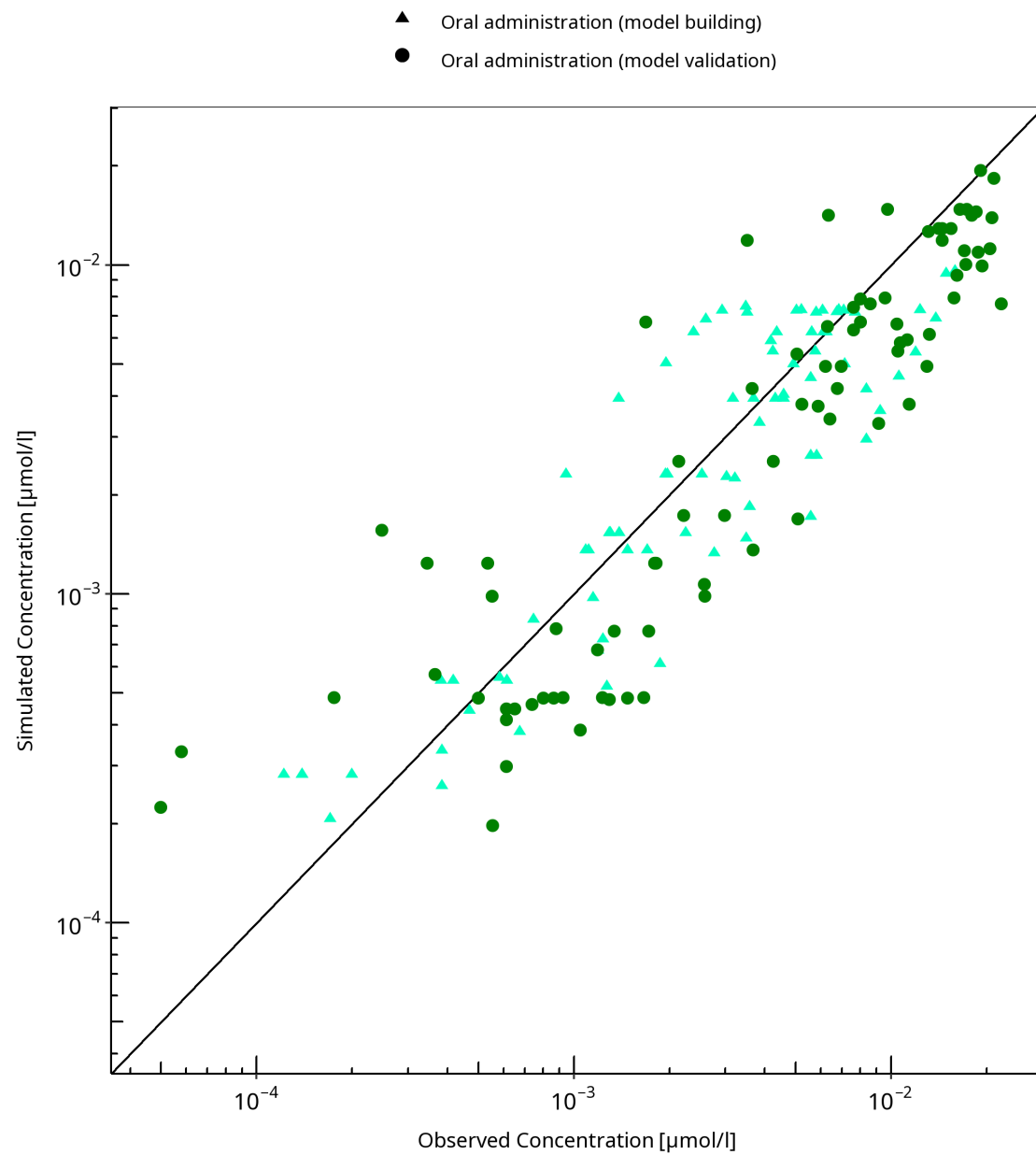


Figure 3-1: Tizanidine concentration in plasma

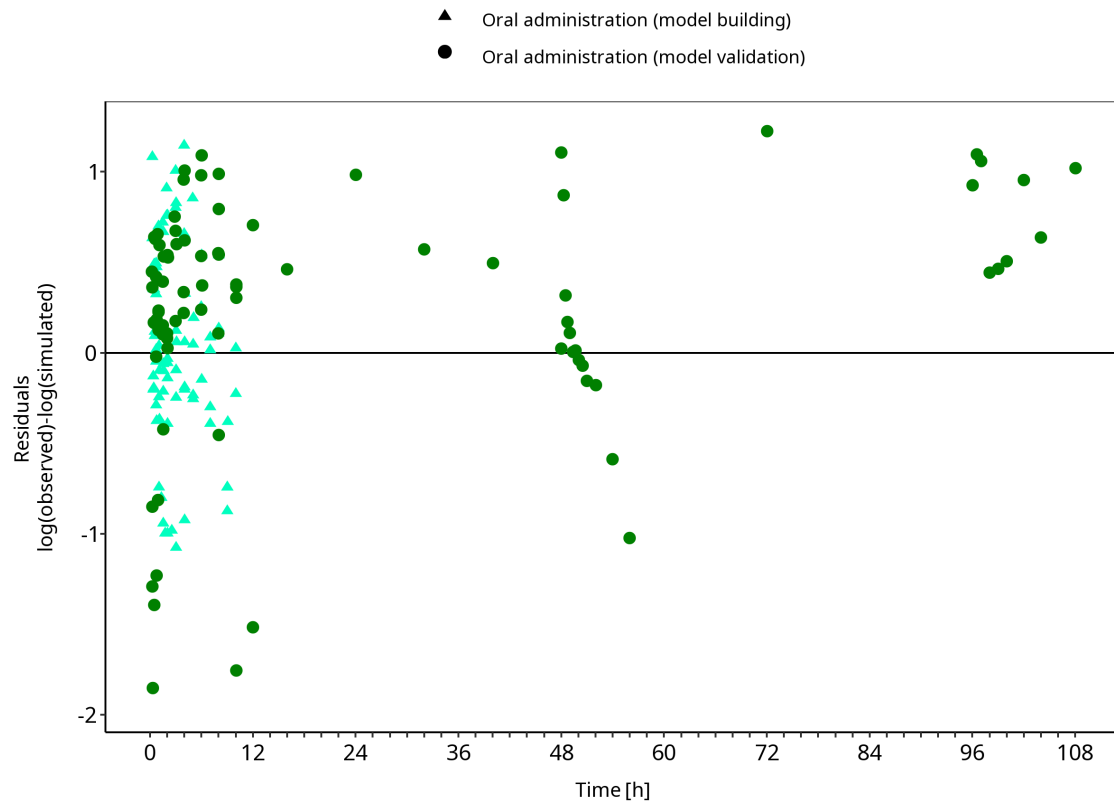


Figure 3-2: Tizanidine concentration in plasma

3.3 Concentration-Time Profiles

Simulated versus observed concentration-time profiles of all data listed in [Section 2.2.2](#) are presented below.

3.3.1 Model Building

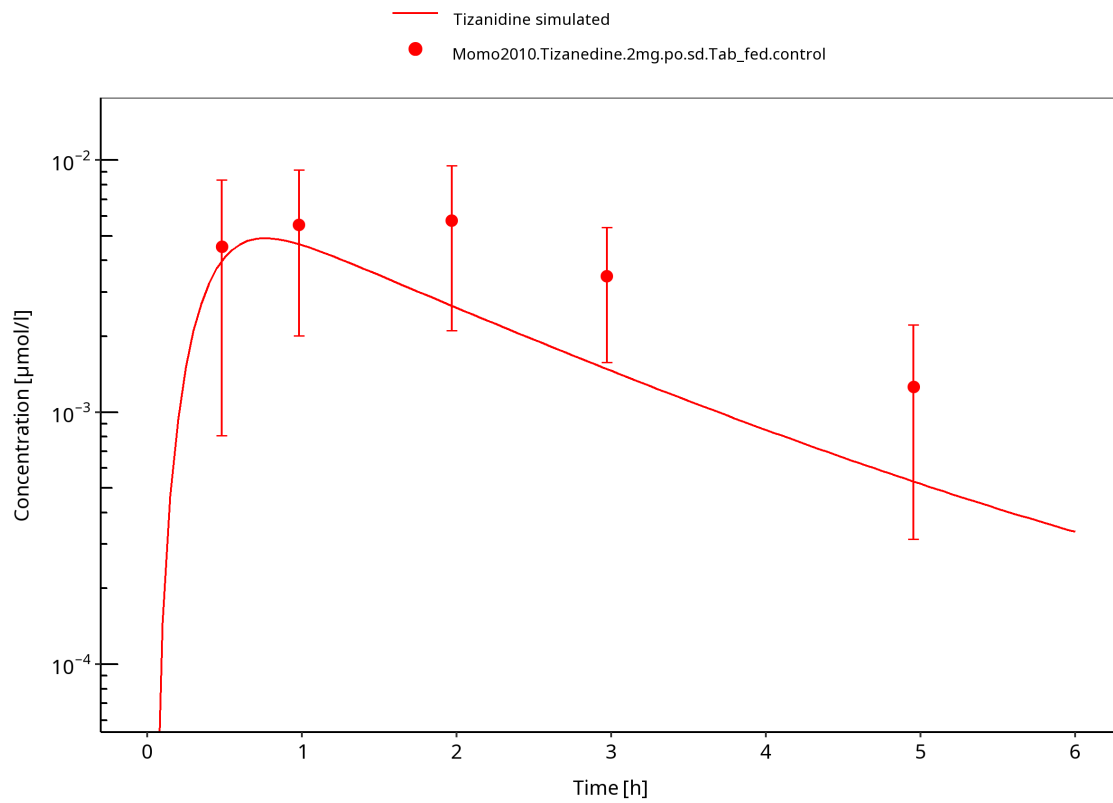


Figure 3-3: Tizanidine 2mg po tablet fed

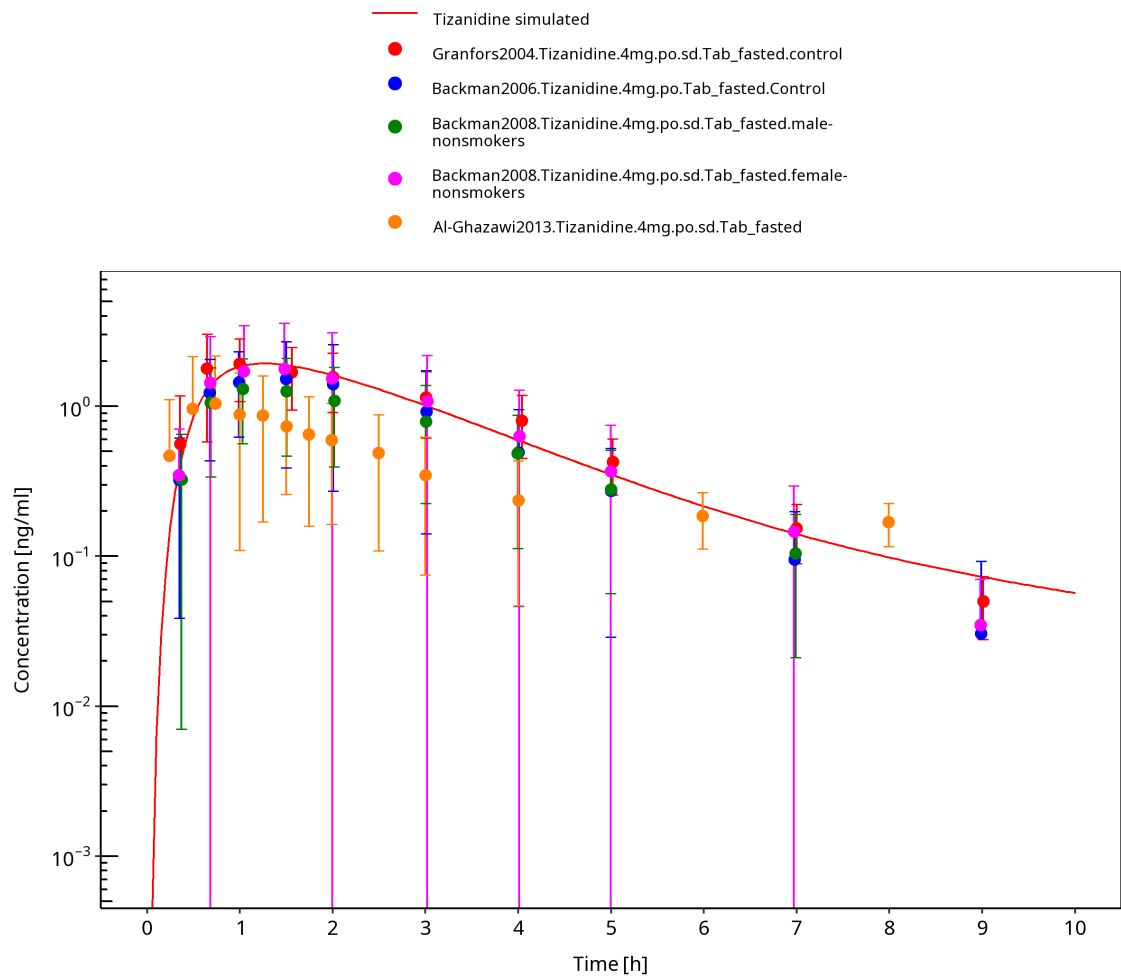


Figure 3-4: Tizanidine 4mg po tablet fasted

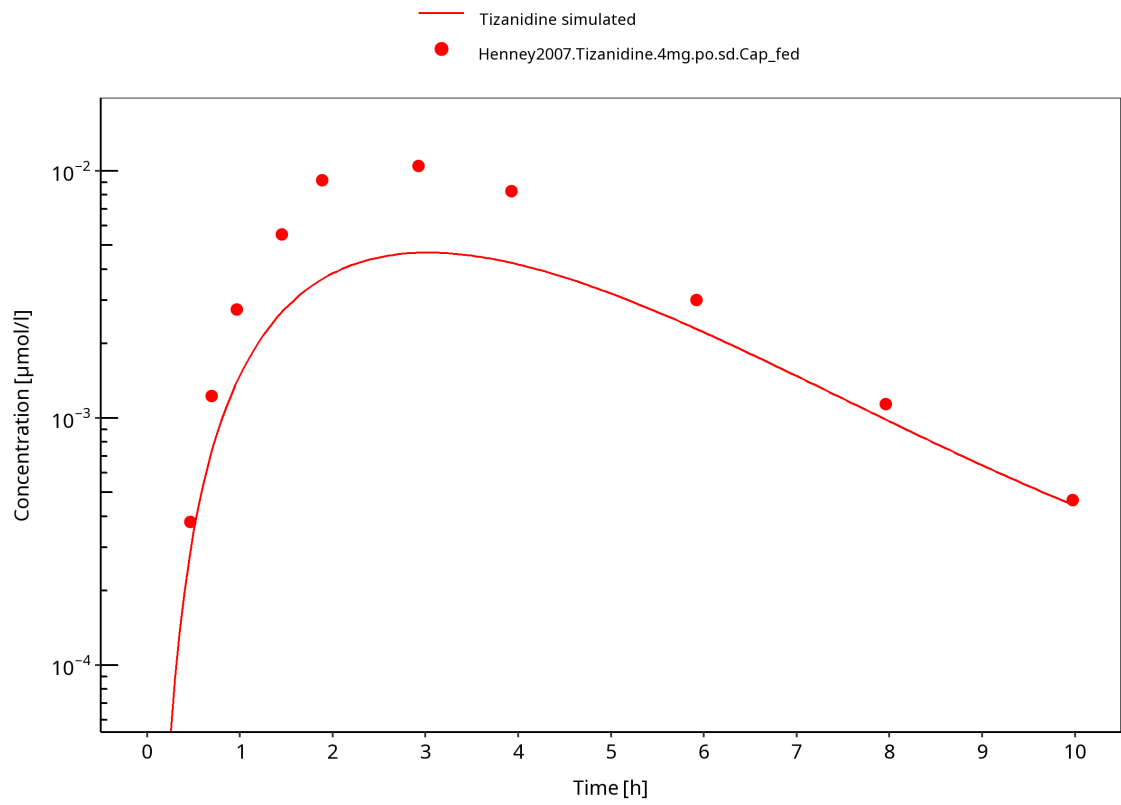


Figure 3-5: Tizanidine 4mg po capsule fed

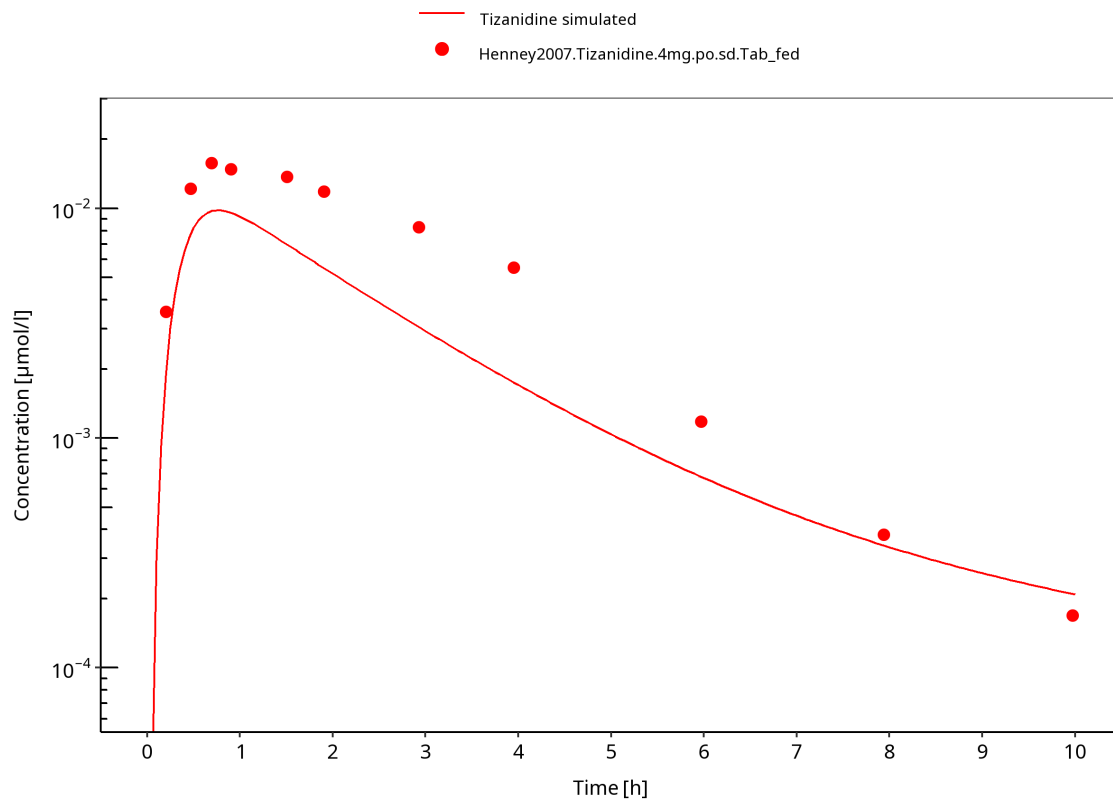


Figure 3-6: Tizanidine 4mg po tablet fed

3.3.2 Model Verification

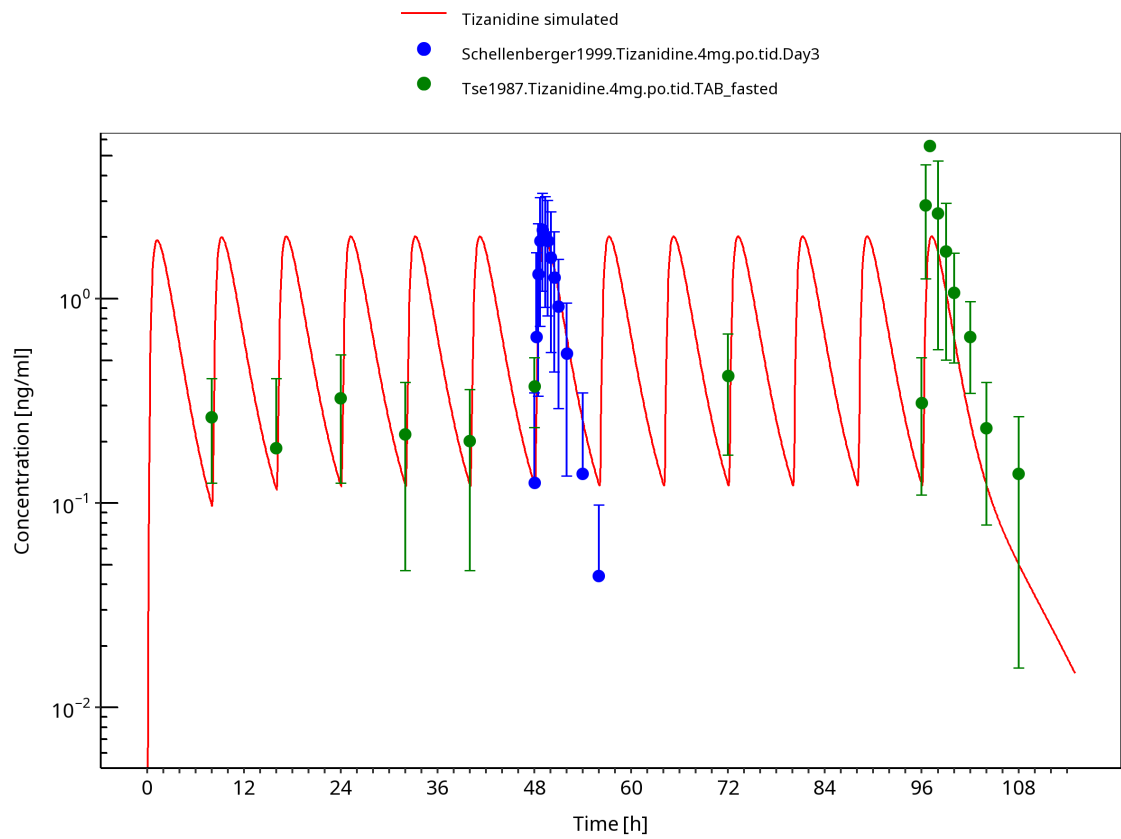


Figure 3-7: Tizanidine 4mg tid po tablet fasted

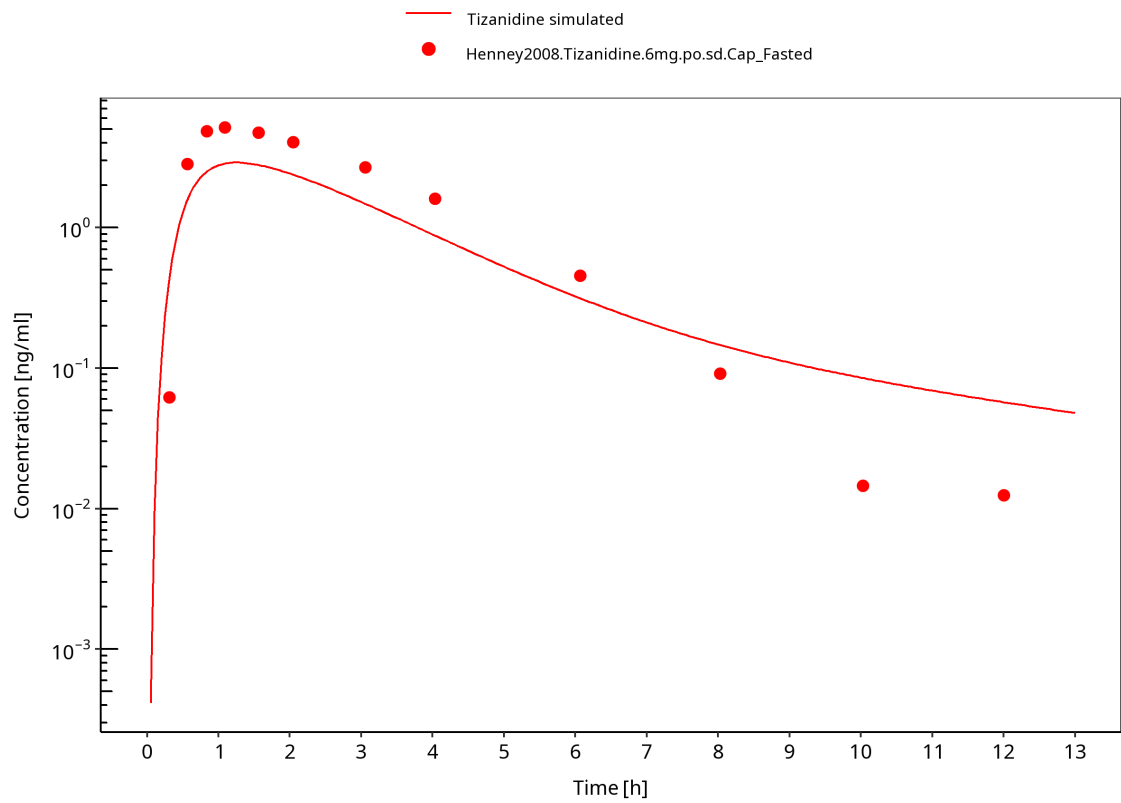


Figure 3-8: Tizanidine 6mg po capsule fasted

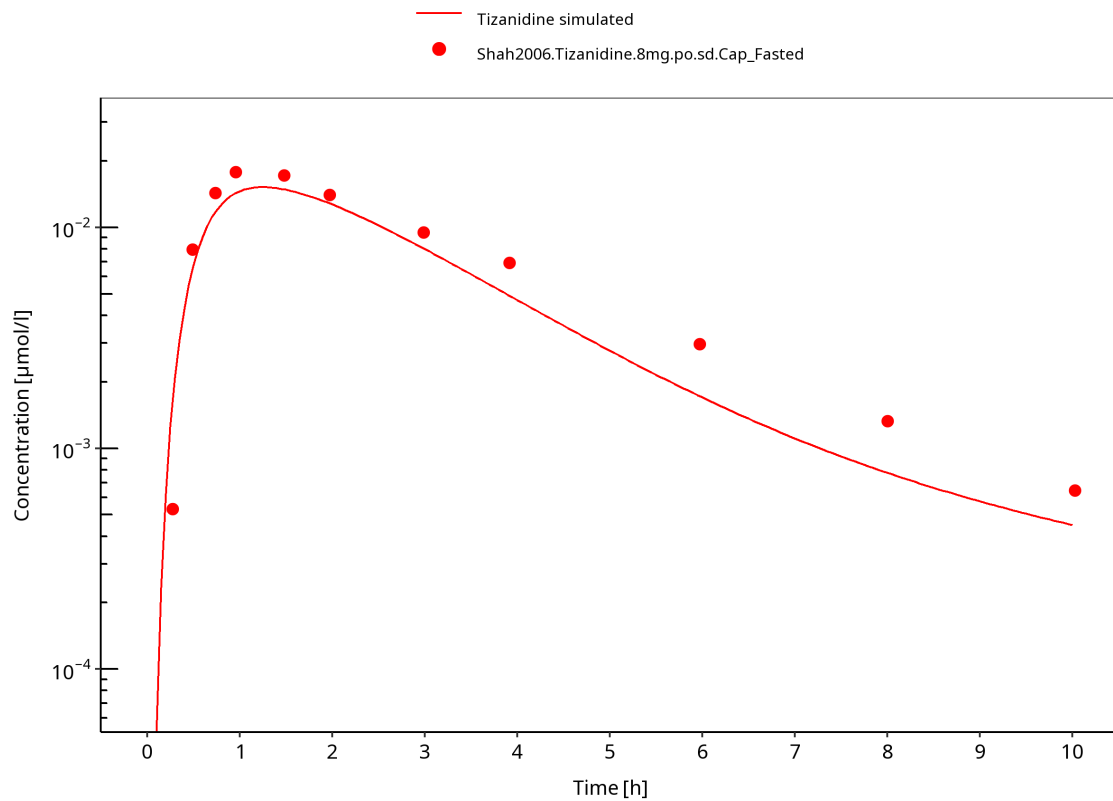


Figure 3-9: Tizanidine 8mg po capsule fasted

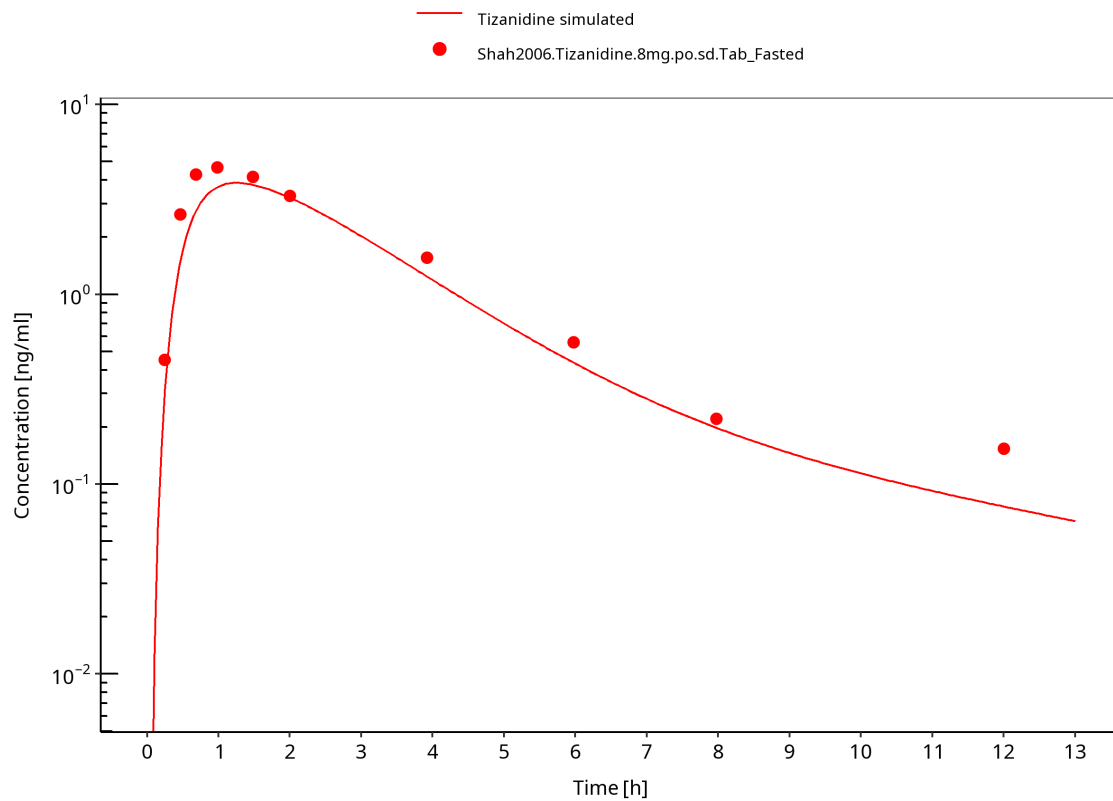


Figure 3-10: Tizanidine 8mg po tablet fasted

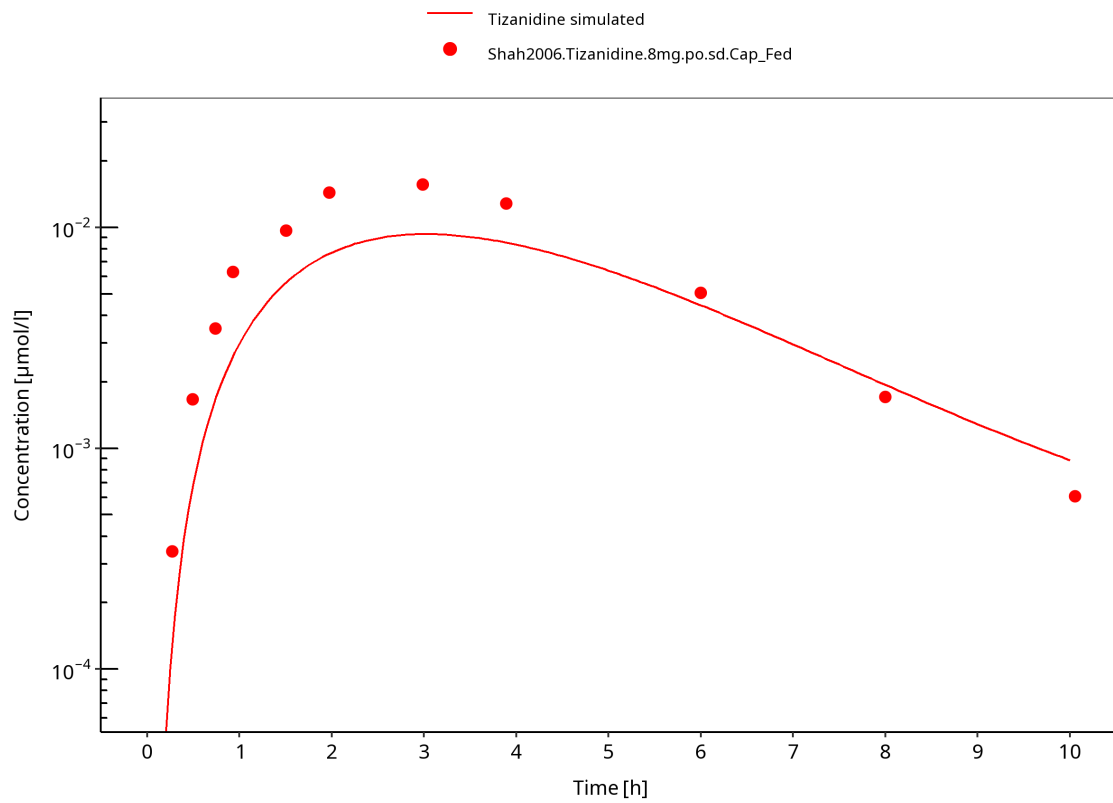


Figure 3-11: Tizanidine 8mg po capsule fed

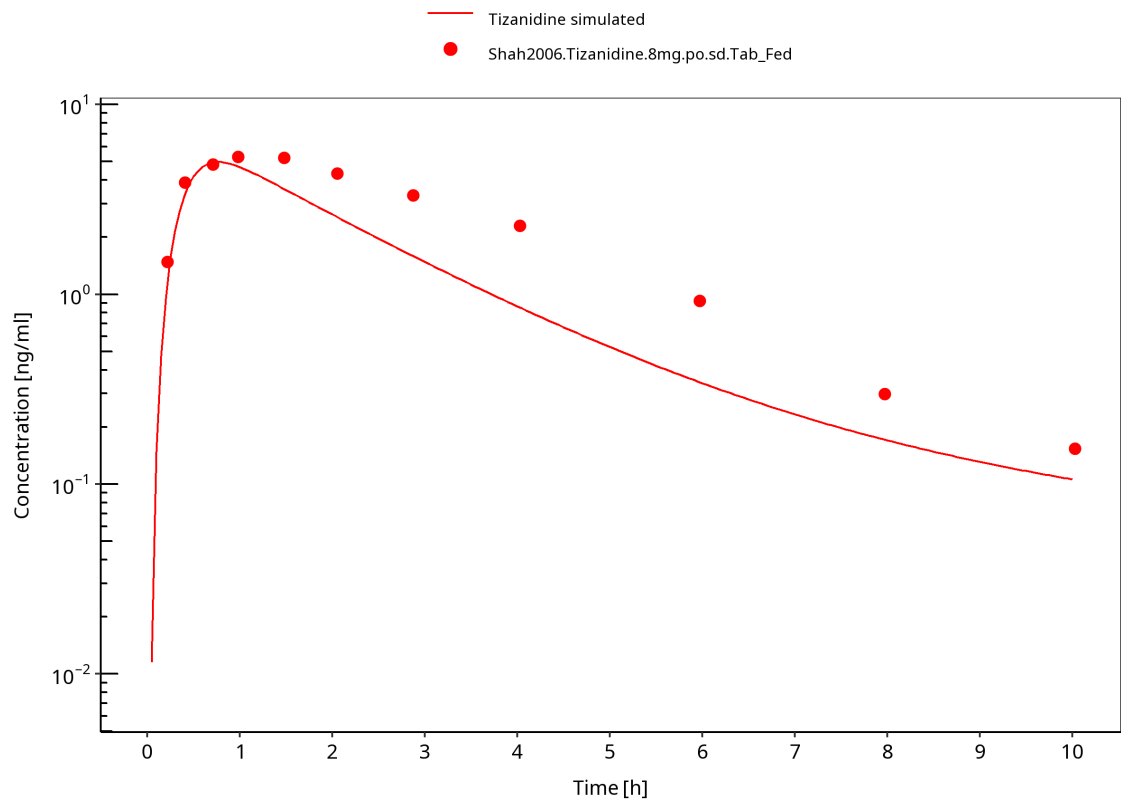


Figure 3-12: Tizanidine 8mg po tablet fed

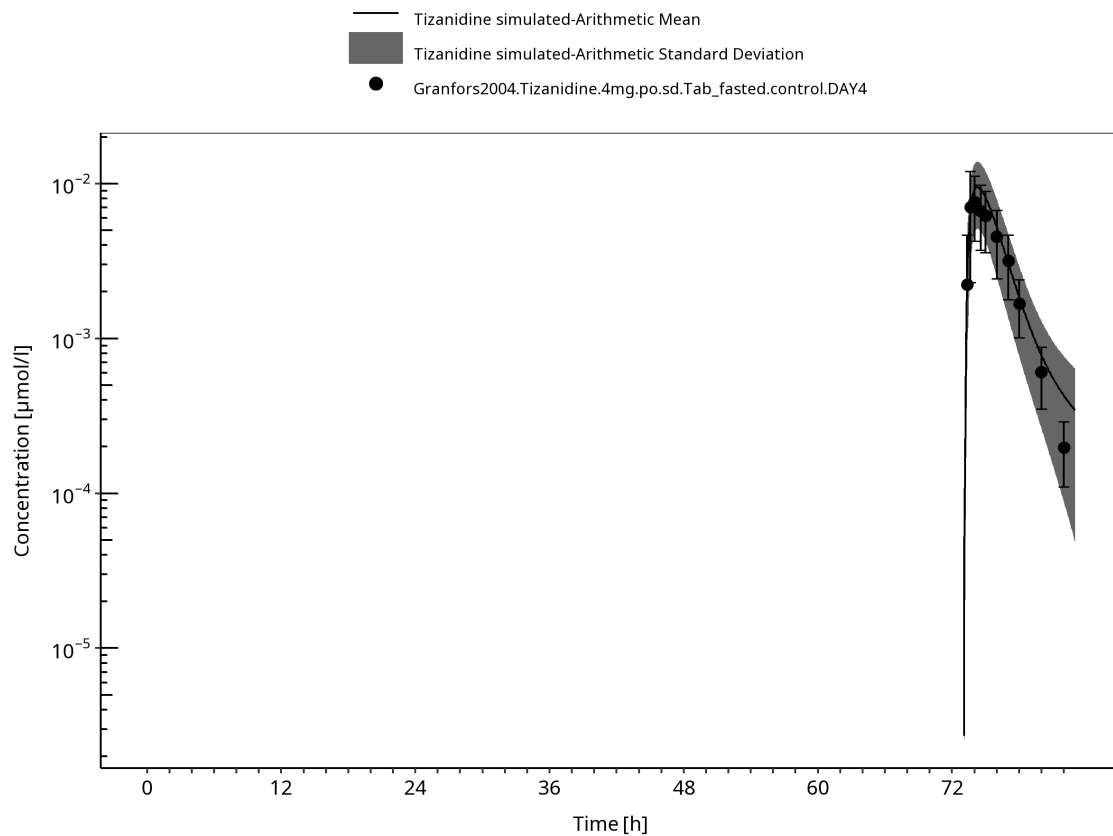


Figure 3-13: Time Profile Analysis

4 Conclusion

The PBPK model developed for tizanidine accurately predicts the time-profiles following single and multiple dosing of tizanidine. Population simulations show that predicted PK variability is in accordance with the literature.

The renal elimination is limited to glomerular filtration only. The predicted small fraction eliminated in Urine (~1%) is in line with literature reports (<5%). Given the minor contribution of the renal pathway no further exploration of active secretion was considered as the impact on DDI predictions is likely small.

Observed data suggests that administration of food accelerates the dissolution of tizanidine tablets, which is modeled through a separate set of parameter values. The effect of food on the capsule could not be described well in terms of peak concentrations. DDI predictions should be restricted to the tablet formulation. The f_a estimated by PK-Sim was 1.0 in both fed and fasted condition, indicating that f_a was not the limiting factor in this model.

As the model was developed in non-smoking subjects, it cannot be used to predict tizanidine concentrations in smokers.

5 References

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6 Glossary

ADME	Absorption, Distribution, Metabolism, Excretion
AUC	Area under the plasma concentration versus time curve
AUCinf	AUC until infinity
AUClast	AUC until last measurable sample
AUCR	Area under the plasma concentration versus time curve Ratio
b.i.d.	Twice daily (bis in diem)
CL	Clearance
Clint	Intrinsic liver clearance
Cmax	Maximum concentration
CmaxR	Maximum concentration Ratio
CYP	Cytochrome P450 oxidase
CYP1A2	Cytochrome P450 1A2 oxidase
CYP2C19	Cytochrome P450 2C19 oxidase
CYP3A4	Cytochrome P450 3A4 oxidase
DDI	Drug-drug interaction
e.c.	Enteric coated
EE	Ethinylestradiol
EM	Extensive metabolizers
fm	Fraction metabolized
FMO	Flavin-containing monooxygenase
fu	Fraction unbound
FDA	Food and Drug administration
GFR	Glomerular filtration rate
HLM	Human liver microsomes
hm	homozygous

ADME	Absorption, Distribution, Metabolism, Excretion
ht	heterozygous
IM	Intermediate metabolizers
i.v.	Intravenous
IVIVE	In Vitro to In Vivo Extrapolation
Ka	Absorption rate constant
kcat	Catalyst rate constant
Ki	Inhibitor constant
Kinact	Rate of enzyme inactivation
Km	Michaelis Menten constant
m.d.	Multiple dose
OSP	Open Systems Pharmacology
PBPK	Physiologically-based pharmacokinetics
PK	Pharmacokinetics
PI	Parameter identification
PM	Poor metabolizers
RT-PCR	Reverse transcription polymerase chain reaction
p.o.	Per os
q.d.	Once daily (quaque diem)
SD	Single Dose
SE	Standard error
s.d.SPC	Single dose Summary of Product Characteristics
SD	Standard deviation
TDI	Time dependent inhibition
t.i.d	Three times a day (ter in die)

ADME	Absorption, Distribution, Metabolism, Excretion
UGT	Uridine 5'-diphospho-glucuronosyltransferase
UM	Ultra-rapid metabolizers